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news
weekly
azine



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stacker news zine

read the best posts every week

created by @plebpoet

Note from the Editor

We've come through a pretty rough summer for bitcoin, but on stacker news, real people are here just living their lives and sharing about it. All the best to you, stackers!

Keep your projects anonymous or put your reputation behind them?



6729 sats \ 19 comments \ **@anon** 20 Sep AskSN tech bitcoin

I run a few Bitcoin-related services. So far, I've kept them anonymous and independent: privacy feels like a good default, and I like the projects standing on their own rather than being about me. There's also value in not having someone's misuse of a service immediately become my problem publicly.

But there's an opportunity cost. I've built a reputation under my nym, and linking these projects to it (and to each other) could help attract users and earn their trust. It's also easier to launch new ones reusing existing infrastructure rather than bootstrapping everything from scratch each time (domain, VPS, LN node, ...).

My main threat model is state scrutiny, particularly visibility into my activity and income.

I also wonder whether different services deserve different approaches. Would you treat something like a LN routing node differently from a SaaS style online service?

For those building in Bitcoin: do you keep projects anonymous, give each a separate nym, or publicly associate them with your main identity? Do you register a company and comply with all taxes and regulations for the services you provide? Obviously reply as anon not mentioning your project if not.

I'm especially interested in first-hand experiences: when has attaching your reputation helped, when has public ownership become a liability, and what made you change your mind? How strict are you with the separation from your nym?

Basically: is this sensible privacy, or am I letting "fear" cost me users, trust, and recognition? What framework do you use to decide?

< comments following >>

1204 sats \ 4 replies \ **@ek** 20 Sep

These are good questions. It's good that you have a threat model. I've been there, and I came to the conclusion that trying to hide and never make a single mistake isn't worth it if the state is your threat model. I tend not to underestimate the state. They can be very incompetent, but I think if the state really wants to find you, they will, unless you're diligent 24/7. And I already have sleep problems.

So either what I'm doing isn't worth their interest anyway, or I'd have to live a life I don't want to live.

> *"when has attaching your reputation helped"*

In my case, it helped in ways I wouldn't have imagined. Two examples: I gave a talk at bitcoin++ in Berlin. A few months later, in Brazil, people recognized me and offered me the opportunity to be a mentor for new bitcoin contributors. I was very surprised that they even knew my name: "You're considering me? Thank you, but why?" "Because we saw you talk in Berlin. You know enough about bitcoin to talk about it on a stage."

My Signal link is on my website. A VC reached out because of a prediction-market prototype I built many years ago and put on GitHub. I'm not sure they would have bothered to reach out if I had been trying to hide my identity.

YMMV

1145 sats \ 0 replies \ **@anon** 21 Sep

This is a very interesting question and one that I have been pondering lately. I registered a company some time ago in order to offer BTC payment services to merchants, but the only way to do that is to KYC your clients and get a compliance officer etc. I really do not want to do all of that, simply because it goes against my own principles and all of what BTC is supposed to solve. I thought it wouldn't be so hard and that complying would open me doors to financing, sponsors and all that, but the cost overhead is so huge that I finally ditched that path.

I still want to offer those services and I will eventually, but not by playing by those rules. I am not too worried on getting identified as it will be mostly a petty crime, with very little amounts and it would be very hard to provably link my identity to it.

As for reputation, I guess I just want to do that one single thing and keep making it better, reputation maybe will get linked to a nym?

Thanks for your post, actually I now have more questions than what I just answered.



1191 sats \ 0 replies \ **@justin_shocknet** 21 Sep

I could write treatise on why hiding from the state is a bad idea and an effort in futility, but anyone that doesn't want to believe it won't. So I'll distill into some bullets, reply if you want a double-click on any.

- Unless your particular state is some banana republic with no resources, it has the drop on you
- If your state is a banana republic with no resources, they are a vassal to a larger country/multinational org who has the drop on you
- You will fuck up your opsec at some point, likely in a way you can't even fully comprehend
- They probably won't care unless you get big and make them look bad
- If you get big and they don't like it they won't like that you hid even more, you turn what might be a sternly worded letter into more serious charges
- You close the doors to them to provide an off-ramp and not expose how they have the drop on you, such as a forced sale to a national champion
- You spend more time trying to preserve anonymity than on product
- Any narrative you might have about why the service/product should be or is legal gets undermined by the fact you hid, and you start drifting further away from that narrative until it catches up with you

The other reasons might be good, some not so good. A/B testing is a good one. Staying anon from the public might be good, but can be done without hiding from the state proper.

The operator does recognize they are operating from a place of fear rather than from a position of achieving goals. It is a reasonable goal to stay anon if you also don't care about growth and just want to stay under the radar keeping such projects as a side hustle for beer money. There's no right or wrong goal, just need to be clear which it is.

My hot water mines Bitcoin and cooks food, with canola oil



38.3k sats \ 27 comments \ [@revhodi21](#) 22 Sep bitcoin_Mining

Cooking hash-vidé style rabbit ramen with Bitcoin mining hot water heater



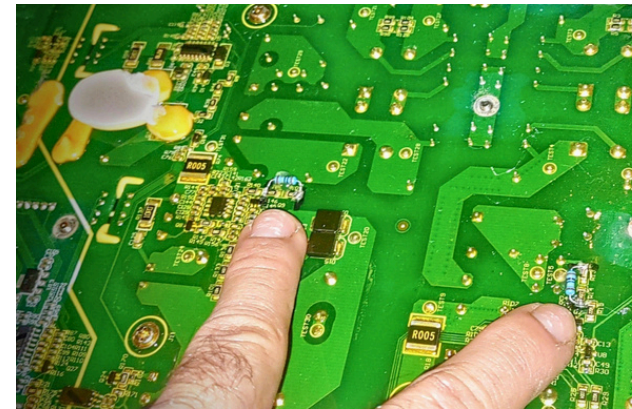
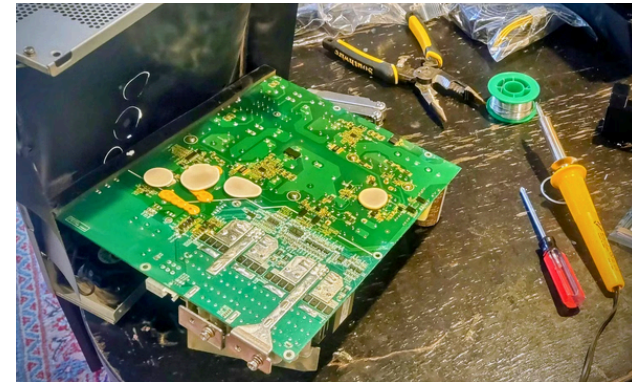
All ingredients went into a silicone bag and submerged in the hot canola oil tank of the bitcoin mining hot water heater for 3 days. Hard to beat mining Bitcoin, heating water, and cooking food all at the same time.

I can get the water up to 150f out of the tap with only 1500w of power consumption for the total system, miner, pumps, and all!

The second meal cooked in the Bitcoin mining hot water heater is rabbit ramen soup. Rabbit grown and harvested right here at the homestead, along with these other ingredients from the homestead rabbit stock, garlic, and finally golden oyster mushrooms dehydrated with a Bitcoin miner. Soy sauce, rice vinegar, lemon, sesame oil, Japanese seven spice, salt, pepper, butter.



Another super cool aspect of this mining setup is that it runs on 110v power instead of 220v. Not having access to a 220v circuit is often a limiting factor for pleb miners, especially when these sorts of applications don't always require so much power. By modifying the apw12 PSU and making a custom power cord, now I can plug the miner into an existing 110v circuit. It cost less than \$20 to do the modification on the PSU plus using a modified apw12 vs a Loki + apw3++ allows for voltage attenuation and higher total power output.



6 sats \ 0 replies \ [@Scoresby](#) 22 Sep

"Bitcoin miner rabbit ramen sous vide in canola oil" is the best thing I've read all month! Amen!

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125 sats \ 2 replies \ [@martinbarilik](#) 23 Sep

sous vide with canola oil, nice. I am glad, i was worried you eat the canola oil as well, that'd be very bad for your health (seed oil hater here)

53 sats \ 1 reply \ [@revhodi21](#) OP 23 Sep

no seed oils consumed. I actually use the spent oil as bar and chain oil in my chainsaws as well as oil in the gearbox of my brush chopper. planning on trying to make sawdust logs with it and heat the house this winter too.

66 sats \ 0 replies \ [@martinbarilik](#) 24 Sep

i am happy for you !!! that is exactly how it's supposed be used, that is how it was used from the start ;)

Meme Monday – Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter

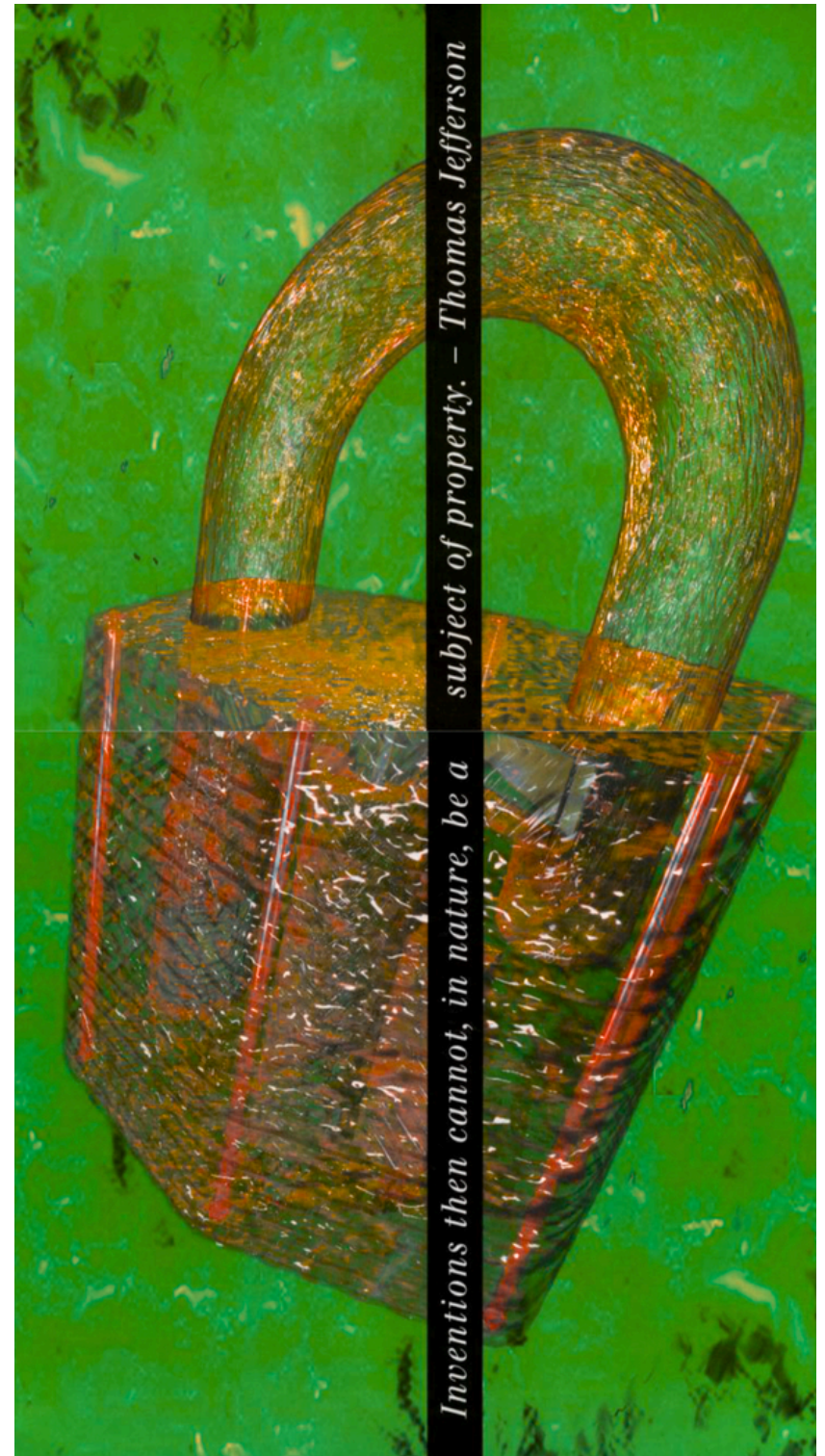
854 sats \ 6 comments \ @sn 21 Sep memes

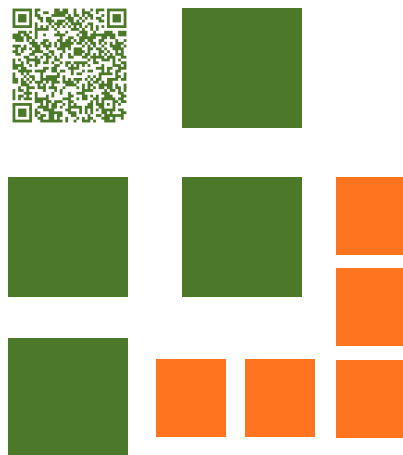


412 sats \ 0 replies \ @fiatbad 21 Sep



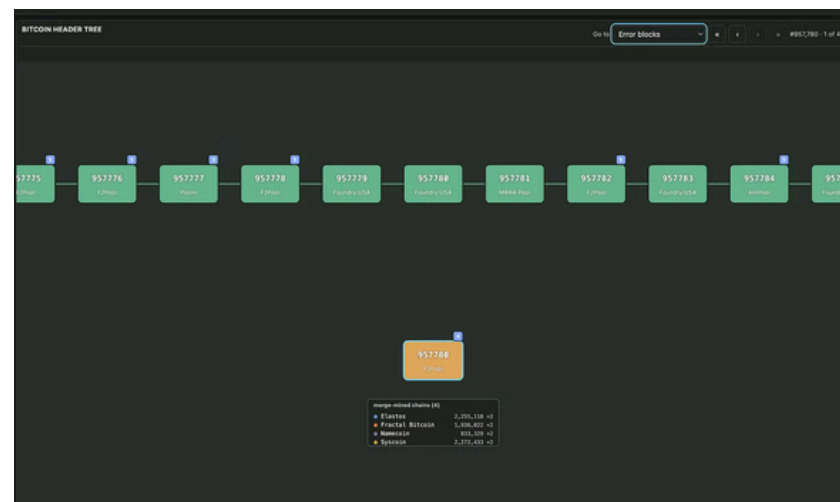
22 sats \ 0 replies \ @AG 23 Sep



[illegible]

- **The two F2Pool headers from April and July this year have timestamps roughly 7 and 14 days below their parents' median time past.** Both were found in merge-mined auxiliary chains; neither has a known Bitcoin-side capture.
- **Auxiliary chains preserve 49 of the 143 headers,** and provide the catalogue's only recorded observation for 35. They check their own rules, so they can preserve evidence of candidates that Bitcoin peers reject.
- **89 blocks contain the same P2SH-invalid transaction,** mined between April and July 2012. Archived transaction lists and preserved headers establish its inclusion in each.
- **127 of the 143 have no complete body.** The surviving headers, coinbases or transaction inclusion proofs, together with chain context, still establish the failures.
- Another 10 reported cases remain separate because the evidence is insufficient.

In my merge mining monitor tool you can step through all invalid-blocks discovered in the merge-mined record (note that invalid blocks are currently called error blocks, this was the language I originally used):



Zine about OP_CAT 🐱

16.4k sats \ 10 comments \ @satsie 22 Sep
bitcoin bitdevs Education



Hi all, I made a zine about OP_CAT.

OP_CAT may be an unusual choice as it's no longer a hot topic and it was even, dare I say, a bit controversial when it was released. But I choose it because it's very simple to understand, even if you don't know much about bitcoin Script or opcodes.

Concatenation, which is what the "CAT" in OP_CAT stands for, is computer science 101. It's a powerful building block with great versatility. OP_CAT has some fun Satoshi lore and it's a gentle entry point into ongoing discussions about covenants and soft forks.

Read the full zine here, then head to my website to download a free copy to print and share with friends:



Special thank you to everyone that made this possible:

- @bitcoin_devs for sponsoring this zine
- @OpenSats for covering the costs of physical printing and distribution for all my zines
- the OP_CAT BIP authors, Ethan Heilman and Armin Sabouri for the countless rounds of feedback and review that went into this
- @spiralbtc for the herecomesbitcoin.org Bitty assets I love so much

While I'm not able to write zines as fast as I'd like, they are still something I love to do and want to continue with. I have a big backlog of ideas I want to tackle but if there are any specific topics you'd like to see covered, drop a comment here.

Thanks everyone for your support. It means a lot. Enjoy!

How would you acquire a new language?



4023 sats \ 50 comments \ @ek 23 Sep AskSN Travel

I want to learn Dutch.

Since it's similar to German, I understand it when I read it (or I press random buttons at the self-checkout until I do), but when I hear it, I'm from a different planet, and not from the neighbouring country. If someone is talking to me, then I smile awkwardly and ask in English if they could repeat it in German or English. I still don't know if it would actually make more sense to ask this in German because of the similarities, but since I struggle with understanding Dutch as a German, it's probably the other way around, too. I'm also used to defaulting to English the moment I cross the German border. Anyway.



Since the 2140 office is in Amsterdam, with many regular and visiting cool people, I consider learning Dutch a great investment. I've been in the Netherlands for more than two months now, and I'm finally embarrassed enough. My current Airbnb host struggles with English, so we tried to talk to each other with

Google Translate. I wanted to tell her that she could also speak into the translator, but the whole situation was already messy enough, so I just patiently waited until she finished her message in Dutch and fixed all her typos. When I could read in English what she wanted to tell me (it was what I already thought but wasn't sure), we were both so relieved that we gave each other a high five and laughed. The situation was so ridiculous that we almost started to just use hand movements. One time I didn't even know the name for dustpan in German or English, so I just made the hand movement on the ground and she immediately understood it. That was fun, but I made a mental note to seriously learn Dutch and not just wing it and continue putting other people in this situation. Anyway, again.

In January, I used Duolingo to learn a bit of Portuguese for bitcoin++ in Brazil. It helped, but I was still completely stranded. My Portuguese and the airport staff's English were almost not good enough to order a hamburger. Duolingo prepared me to become a barista with sentences like "Um café ou um chá?"

...

Anyway, anyway, anyway. A lot of words to ask you: how would you ~~learn~~ acquire a new language? > > >

347 sats \ 15 replies \ **@MrGlass** 23 Sep

As a Dutch person... just use English and save yourself the hassle... Dutch grammar is a mess, even for me. A gazillion exceptions, without logic. Dutch people will switch to English effortlessly and usually do not mind at all.

The fact that you have an Airbnb host, in Amsterdam no less, that does not speak English, is beyond me... you really won the lottery there lol...

199 sats \ 6 replies \ **@npub1zapsats** 23 Sep

I have been trying to learn French for years and still struggling with comprehension as you say

Reading writing speaking are intermediate but listening is the weakest discipline for me

Also french is basically a dead language like Latin, I mean apart from the French who are super protective of it, who else uses it? A few bygone former french colonies, Senegal, ivory coast, Algeria perhaps but even they prefer Arabic I've tried evening school, Duolingo, apps, but I find proof of work is the only real way if you can't live in said country, so I literally take a video and slow it down and break it down piece by piece

The problem with french is, they have classroom french and street french, which I suppose they have for any language but the spoken way drops parts that are always written

My goal is to be able to listen to a political or cultural debate on french TV where there are 4 or 5 guests all shouting over each other lol

I should imagine Dutch is like french in that, it's only used in Holland and a few colonies like Aruba for example, I'm wondering if the Flemish region of Belgium is a type of Dutch?

↳ 119 sats \ 3 replies \ **@optimism** 23 Sep

Flemish and Dutch have the same origin in terms of language. Neither that or French are dead languages though lol

262 sats \ 3 replies \ **@optimism** 23 Sep

Note: Learning Dutch is **no great investment** at all because you can just speak English, anywhere, especially in Amsterdam. Nevertheless, I did it too.

For me, not having much education in German prior, it was harder for me to learn German after Dutch, because Germans simply do not understand a word I say. I think the other way around ought to be easier and I know a bunch of Germans that think so too, but every native speaker will be rolling their eyes with every *germanising* you'll pollute their language with (whereas they will not do that if you insert any English word anywhere)

For me, I worked with a bunch of Dutch people and I spent a lot of evenings in the pubs so I just picked it up like that at first, and then I took some classes because "street Dutch" is like English without self-censoring any bad word. It's probably better to do it the other way around: start with some classes.

Stacker Watch

4239 sats \ 14 comments \
@Catcher 24 Sep news AI



I like installing iOS betas. Not sure why, I just love it. So when iOS 27 came out in June (or whenever it was exactly), I installed the first beta. A couple of days later I was browsing some website on my iPhone and needed to zoom out, but Safari wouldn't let me do it with a pinch. I went looking for page scale in settings, couldn't find it anywhere, and that's when I stumbled on an interesting Safari feature called "Describe Extension". I was like, ok, describing: I need to zoom out. Safari thought for a second, "vibecoded" the extension for me, and it actually worked. Wow, ok.

That's when I thought the future phone is basically a device that does whatever you tell it to, with no apps preinstalled. Then I forgot about the idea.

Fast forward to September. I listened to the Lex podcast with DHH. I never listen to Lex, but I'd run out of episodes from the podcasts I'm subscribed to. What struck me most was DHH saying something like: I like this notes app, but I only use about 10% of its features, so everything else is a distraction, so I just told Claude to rebuild the app and get rid of the stuff I don't use. That's not the exact quote, but you get the idea.

I remember listening and thinking, why don't I do the same?

I've now built 3 apps I use every day that follow the same idea. There was something I liked but not quite, so I rebuilt it to fix my issues and tweak it for myself.

So that's the background to today's post.

I don't know what % of people like reading news on the Apple Watch, but I'm one of them. Sometimes I just want short summaries on a small screen: when I'm somewhere it's not convenient to use the phone, when the phone is in another room, when I go to bed, etc.

But every app I've used to read news on the watch is shitty, and the news is shitty too.

So yesterday I thought, why not read Stacker News on the watch? I even installed a browser for the Apple Watch to try it. It was a pain in the ass, and by the time the page finally opened you're already tired.

So today I made a Stacker News app for the Apple Watch. There's no login, it's just a news app for the watch, but with Stacker News. I use it as my news app now, so if you're in the 0.01% of people who also read news on their watch, feel free to grab it via TestFlight =)

